

UI/UX Design with Figma - Hour 4: Layout and Grids

Hour 4: Layout and Grids in Figma (2 Academic Hours)

- Goal: Teach students how to structure and organize content using spacing, grids, alignment, and constraints in UI design.

1. Introduction to Layout and Grids

- Why layouts matter:
 - - Creates order and consistency.
 - - Helps users scan and interact efficiently.
 - - Provides balance and rhythm in the interface.
- Key Concepts:
 - - White space: Space between elements.
 - - Consistency: Uniform spacing increases readability.
 - - Structure: Layouts define content placement.

2. Spacing & Alignment

- Spacing:
 - - Use multiples of 8px (e.g., 8, 16, 24).
 - - Maintain vertical rhythm between text, buttons, images.
 - - Apply padding inside cards and sections.
- Alignment:
 - - Left-aligned for readability.
 - - Center-aligned for headlines and CTAs.
 - - Use Figma's alignment tools: top bar icons for alignment and distribution.
- Exercise: Create a pricing section with 3 cards aligned side-by-side.

3. Introduction to Grids & Columns

- What is a grid system?
 - - Structure of rows/columns to align content.
 - - Common system: 12-column grid.
- Benefits:
 - - Consistent layout and faster decision-making.
 - - Supports responsive design.
- Set Up in Figma:
 - - Select Frame -> Layout Grid -> Add Grid -> Change to Columns.
 - - Columns: 12, Gutter: 16px, Margin: 24px.
- Tip: Apply grids to main containers only.

4. Visual Hierarchy & Constraints

- Hierarchy:
 - - Guide user attention with size, contrast, font weight, spacing.
 - - Header: bold and large; Body: smaller and regular.
- Constraints in Figma:
 - - Pin elements to sides or center using the right-hand panel.
 - - Test responsiveness by resizing the frame.

5. Task: Homepage Layout Using 12-Column Grid

- Design a homepage that includes:
 - - Header with logo and navigation.
 - - Hero section with headline, subtext, CTA button, and image.
 - - Feature section with icons and descriptions.
 - - Footer with links/contact info.
- Use tools such as:
 - - Layout grid (12 columns).
 - - Alignment, spacing, constraints.
 - - Text styles and Auto Layout (optional).

6. Review and Wrap-Up

- Students present homepage designs.
- Review grid use, spacing, alignment, hierarchy.
- Encourage peer feedback via comments or discussion.